Coimisiún na Scrúduithe Stáit
State Examinations Commission

LEAVING CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION, 2024

English - Ordinary Level - Paper 2

Total Marks: 200

3 hours 20 minutes

Candidates must attempt the following:

- The required number of questions on **One** single text from SECTION I – The Single Text
- **ONE** question from SECTION II – The Comparative Study
- **THE QUESTIONS** on the Unseen Poem from SECTION III – Poetry
- The questions on **ONE** of the Prescribed Poems from SECTION III – Poetry

INDEX OF SINGLE TEXTS

All the Light We Cannot See – Page 2
Silas Marner – Page 3
Philadelphia, Here I Come! – Page 4
A Raisin in the Sun – Page 5
The Crucible – Page 6
The Cove – Page 7
Hamlet – Page 8
Frankenstein – Page 9
The Picture of Dorian Gray – Page 10

This document must be handed up at the end of the examination.

SECTION I THE SINGLE TEXT (60 MARKS)

Candidates must answer on **ONE** text (**A – I**).

A All THE LIGHT WE CANNOT SEE – Anthony Doerr

Answer any two of the following four questions. Each question carries 30 marks.

1. (a) Identify a complicated relationship in Doerr's novel, *All the Light We Cannnot See*. Explain one reason why this relationship is complicated. (10)

(b) Are the characters in the complicated relationship you identified in part (a) happy, unhappy or a combination of both? Explain your response with reference to the text. (10)

(c) What is the most valuable lesson you have learned from your study of the complicated relationship you have identified? Support your response with reference to the text. (10)

2. Your local book club has just finished reading Doerr's novel, *All the Light We Cannot See.* You have been asked to give a presentation to the group about the lasting thoughts and feelings you were left with having read the novel. Write the text of the presentation you would give. Support your response with reference to the text.

3. Doerr's novel, *All the Light We Cannot See,* has been described as a fascinating exploration of the challenges faced by characters in the world in which they live. Do you agree or disagree with this view? Support your response with reference to at least one character in the text.

4. To celebrate Reading Week, your English class is staging a series of lunchtime talks about Anthony Doerr's novel, *All the Light We Cannot See*. You have been asked to give a talk focusing on three key moments from the novel that you think an audience would be interested in hearing about. Write the text of the talk you would give, identifying the key moments and explaining the reasons for your choice. Your explanation should demonstrate your knowledge and understanding of the text.

B **SILAS MARNER** – George Eliot

Answer any two of the following four questions. Each question carries 30 marks.

1. (a) Identify a complicated relationship in Eliot's novel, *Silas Marner*. Explain one reason why this relationship is complicated. (10)

(b) Are the characters in the complicated relationship you identified in part (a) happy, unhappy or a combination of both? Explain your response with reference to the text. (10)

(c) What is the most valuable lesson you have learned from your study of the complicated relationship you have identified? Support your response with reference to the text. (10)

2. Your local book club has just finished reading Eliot's novel, *Silas Marner.* You have been asked to give a presentation to the group about the lasting thoughts and feelings you were left with having read the novel. Write the text of the presentation you would give. Support your response with reference to the text.

3. Eliot's novel, *Silas Marner,* has been described as a fascinating exploration of the challenges faced by characters in the world in which they live.
Do you agree or disagree with this view? Support your response with reference to at least one character in the text.

4. To celebrate Reading Week, your English class is staging a series of lunchtime talks about Eliot's novel, *Silas Marner*. You have been asked to give a talk focusing on three key moments from the novel that you think an audience would be interested in hearing about. Write the text of the talk you would give, identifying the key moments and explaining the reasons for your choice. Your explanation should demonstrate your knowledge and understanding of the text.

C PHILADELPHIA, HERE I COME! – Brian Friel

Answer any two of the following four questions. Each question carries 30 marks.

1. (a) Identify a complicated relationship in Friel's play, *Philadelphia, Here I Come!*. Explain one reason why this relationship is complicated. (10)

(b) Are the characters in the complicated relationship you identified in part (a) happy, unhappy or a combination of both? Explain your response with reference to the text. (10)

(c) What is the most valuable lesson you have learned from your study of the complicated relationship you have identified? Support your response with reference to the text. (10)

2. Your local drama group has just attended a production of Friel's play, *Philadelphia, Here I Come!*. You have been asked to give a presentation to the group about the lasting thoughts and feelings you were left with having watched the play. Write the text of the presentation you would give. Support your response with reference to the text.

3. Brian Friel's play, *Philadelphia, Here I Come!,* has been described as a fascinating exploration of the challenges faced by characters in the world in which they live. Do you agree or disagree with this view? Support your response with reference to at least one character in the text.

4. To celebrate Drama Week, English classes in your school are staging scenes from the plays they are studying. Your class is to stage a scene from Brian Friel's play, *Philadelphia, Here I Come!*. Identify the scene that your class has chosen to stage and explain three reasons why you think an audience would be interested in watching this scene. Your explanation should demonstrate your knowledge and understanding of the text.

D **A RAISIN IN THE SUN** – Lorraine Hansberry

Answer any two of the following four questions. Each question carries 30 marks.

1. (a) Identify a complicated relationship in Hansberry's play, *A Raisin in the Sun*. Explain one reason why this relationship is complicated. (10)

(b) Are the characters in the complicated relationship you identified in part (a) happy, unhappy or a combination of both? Explain your response with reference to the text. (10)

(c) What is the most valuable lesson you have learned from your study of the complicated relationship you have identified? Support your response with reference to the text. (10)

2. Your local drama group has just attended a production of Hansberry's play, *A Raisin in The Sun.* You have been asked to give a presentation to the group about the lasting thoughts and feelings you were left with having watched the play. Write the text of the presentation you would give. Support your response with reference to the text.

3. Hansberry's play, *A Raisin in the Sun,* has been described as a fascinating exploration of the challenges faced by characters in the world in which they live.
Do you agree or disagree with this view? Support your response with reference to at least one character in the text.

4. To celebrate Drama Week, English classes in your school are staging scenes from the plays they are studying. Your class is to stage a scene from Lorraine Hansberry's play, *A Raisin in the Sun*. Identify the scene that your class has chosen to stage and explain three reasons why you think an audience would be interested in watching this scene. Your explanation should demonstrate your knowledge and understanding of the text.

E THE CRUCIBLE – Arthur Miller

Answer any two of the following four questions. Each question carries 30 marks.

1. (a) Identify a complicated relationship in Miller's play, *The Crucible*. Explain one reason why this relationship is complicated. (10)

(b) Are the characters in the complicated relationship you identified in part (a) happy, unhappy or a combination of both? Explain your response with reference to the text. (10)

(c) What is the most valuable lesson you have learned from your study of the complicated relationship you have identified? Support your response with reference to the text. (10)

2. Your local drama group has just attended a production of Miller's play, *The Crucible.* You have been asked to give a presentation to the group about the lasting thoughts and feelings you were left with having watched the play. Write the text of the presentation you would give. Support your response with reference to the text.

3. Miller's play, *The Crucible,* has been described as a fascinating exploration of the challenges faced by characters in the world in which they live.
Do you agree or disagree with this view? Support your response with reference to at least one character in the text.

4. To celebrate Drama Week, English classes in your school are staging scenes from the plays they are studying. Your class is to stage a scene from Arthur Miller's play, *The Crucible*. Identify the scene that your class has chosen to stage and explain three reasons why you think an audience would be interested in watching this scene. Your explanation should demonstrate your knowledge and understanding of the text.

F **THE COVE** – Ron Rash

Answer any two of the following four questions. Each question carries 30 marks.

1. (a) Identify a complicated relationship in Rash's novel, *The Cove*. Explain one reason why this relationship is complicated. (10)

(b) Are the characters in the complicated relationship you identified in part (a) happy, unhappy or a combination of both? Explain your response with reference to the text. (10)

(c) What is the most valuable lesson you have learned from your study of the complicated relationship you have identified? Support your response with reference to the text. (10)

2. Your local book club has just finished reading Rash's novel, *The Cove.* You have been asked to give a presentation to the group about the lasting thoughts and feelings you were left with having read the novel. Write the text of the presentation you would give. Support your response with reference to the text.

3. Rash's novel, *The Cove,* has been described as a fascinating exploration of the challenges faced by characters in the world in which they live.
Do you agree or disagree with this view? Support your response with reference to at least one character in the text.

4. To celebrate Reading Week, your English class is staging a series of lunchtime talks about Rash's novel, *The Cove*. You have been asked to give a talk focusing on three key moments from the novel that you think an audience would be interested in hearing about. Write the text of the talk you would give, identifying the key moments and explaining the reasons for your choice. Your explanation should demonstrate your knowledge and understanding of the text.

G **HAMLET** – William Shakespeare

Answer any two of the following four questions. Each question carries 30 marks.

1. (a) Identify a complicated relationship in Shakespeare's play, *Hamlet*. Explain one reason why this relationship is complicated. (10)

(b) Are the characters in the complicated relationship you identified in part (a) happy, unhappy or a combination of both? Explain your response with reference to the text. (10)

(c) What is the most valuable lesson you have learned from your study of the complicated relationship you have identified? Support your response with reference to the text. (10)

2. Your local drama group has just attended a production of Shakespeare's play, *Hamlet.* You have been asked to give a presentation to the group about the lasting thoughts and feelings you were left with having watched the play. Write the text of the presentation you would give. Support your response with reference to the text.

3. Shakespeare's play, *Hamlet,* has been described as a fascinating exploration of the challenges faced by characters in the world in which they live.
Do you agree or disagree with this view? Support your response with reference to at least one character in the text.

4. To celebrate Drama Week, English classes in your school are staging scenes from the plays they are studying. Your class is to stage a scene from Shakespeare's play, *Hamlet.* Identify the scene that your class has chosen to stage and explain three reasons why you think an audience would be interested in watching this scene. Your explanation should demonstrate your knowledge and understanding of the text.

H **FRANKENSTEIN** – Mary Shelley

Answer any two of the following four questions. Each question carries 30 marks.

1. (a) Identify a complicated relationship in Shelley's novel, *Frankenstein*. Explain one reason why this relationship is complicated. (10)

(b) Are the characters in the complicated relationship you identified in part (a) happy, unhappy or a combination of both? Explain your response with reference to the text. (10)

(c) What is the most valuable lesson you have learned from your study of the complicated relationship you have identified? Support your response with reference to the text. (10)

2. Your local book club has just finished reading Shelley's novel, *Frankenstein.* You have been asked to give a presentation to the group about the lasting thoughts and feelings you were left with having read the novel. Write the text of the presentation you would give. Support your response with reference to the text.

3. Shelley's novel, *Frankenstein,* has been described as a fascinating exploration of the challenges faced by characters in the world in which they live.
Do you agree or disagree with this view? Support your response with reference to at least one character in the text.

4. To celebrate Reading Week, your English class is staging a series of lunchtime talks about Shelley's novel, *Frankenstein*. You have been asked to give a talk focusing on three key moments from the novel that you think an audience would be interested in hearing about. Write the text of the talk you would give, identifying the key moments and explaining the reasons for your choice. Your explanation should demonstrate your knowledge and understanding of the text.

I THE PICTURE OF DORIAN GRAY – Oscar Wilde

Answer any two of the following four questions. Each question carries 30 marks.

1. (a) Identify a complicated relationship in Wilde's novel, *The Picture of Dorian Gray*. Explain one reason why this relationship is complicated. (10)

(b) Are the characters in the complicated relationship you identified in part (a) happy, unhappy or a combination of both? Explain your response with reference to the text. (10)

(c) What is the most valuable lesson you have learned from your study of the complicated relationship you have identified? Support your response with reference to the text. (10)

2. Your local book club has just finished reading Wilde's novel, *The Picture of Dorian Gray.* You have been asked to give a presentation to the group about the lasting thoughts and feelings you were left with having read the novel. Write the text of the presentation you would give. Support your response with reference to the text.

3. Wilde's novel, *The Picture of Dorian Gray,* has been described as a fascinating exploration of the challenges faced by characters in the world in which they live.
Do you agree or disagree with this view? Support your response with reference to at least one character in the text.

4. To celebrate Reading Week, your English class is staging a series of lunchtime talks about Wilde's novel, *The Picture of Dorian Gray*. You have been asked to give a talk focusing on three key moments from the novel that you think an audience would be interested in hearing about. Write the text of the talk you would give, identifying the key moments and explaining the reasons for your choice. Your explanation should demonstrate your knowledge and understanding of the text.

SECTION II THE COMPARATIVE STUDY (70 MARKS)

Candidates must answer **ONE** question from **either A** – Hero, Heroine, Villain **or B** – Theme **or C** – Social Setting

Candidates who answer a question in **SECTION I** – The Single Text, may not refer to the same text in answer to questions in this section.

All texts used in this section must be prescribed for comparative study for this year's examination.

Candidates may refer to only one film in the course of their answers.

N.B. Questions use the word **text** to refer to all the different kinds of texts available for study on this course. Questions use the word **character** to refer to both real people and fictional characters in texts. Questions use the word **author** to include all writers and directors of texts.

A HERO, HEROINE, VILLAIN

1. (a) (i) Name **one** text on your comparative course and identify a hero, heroine or villain in it. Use one or more key moment(s) to show how an action or a decision taken by this character had a significant impact on another character. Support your answer with reference to the text. (15)

(ii) Name **another** comparative text you have studied and identify a hero, heroine or villain in it. Use one or more key moment(s) to show how an action or a decision taken by this character had a significant impact on another character. Support your answer with reference to the text. (15)

(b) Identify a hero, heroine or villain from each of **at least two** texts on your comparative course. Compare the extent to which you found these characters inspiring. Support your response with reference to your chosen texts. (40)

OR

2. (a) (i) Name **one** text you studied as part of your comparative course and identify a hero, heroine or villain in it. Describe a key moment when your chosen character behaved in a way that led to an important turning point in that text. Explain why this was an important turning point. Support your response with reference to the text. (15)

(ii) Name **another** text you studied as part of your comparative course and identify a hero, heroine or villain in it. Describe a key moment when your chosen character behaved in a way that led to an important turning point in that text. Explain why this was an important turning point. Support your response with reference to the text. (15)

(b) Identify a hero, heroine or villain from each of **at least two** texts on your comparative course. Compare the extent to which you found these characters inspiring. Support your response with reference to your chosen texts. (40)

B THEME

1. (a) (i) Name **one** text on your comparative course and identify a theme you studied in it. Identify a main character whose treatment of other characters in the text helped you to explore your chosen theme. Use one or more key moment(s) to demonstrate how the main character's treatment of other characters helped you to explore your chosen theme. Support your answer with reference to your chosen text. (15)

(ii) Name **another** text on your comparative course. In relation to the same theme discussed in part (a) (i) above, identify a main character whose treatment of other characters in this text helped you to explore your chosen theme. Use one or more key moment(s) to demonstrate how the main character's treatment of other characters helped you to explore your chosen theme. Support your answer with reference to your chosen text. (15)

(b) Compare the extent to which the exploration of the same theme you discussed in part (a), left you feeling positive or negative, in each of **at least two** texts on your comparative course. Support your answer with reference to your chosen texts. (40)

OR

2. (a) (i) Name **one** of your comparative texts and identify a theme you studied in it. Identify one relationship in the text and using one or more key moment(s) explain what you learned about your chosen theme by studying this relationship in the text. Support your answer with reference to your chosen text. (15)

(ii) Name **another** of your comparative texts. Identify one relationship in this text and using one or more key moment(s) explain what you learned about the same theme you discussed in part (a) (i) above, by studying this relationship in the text. Support your answer with reference to your chosen text. (15)

(b) Compare the extent to which the exploration of the same theme you discussed in part (a), left you feeling positive or negative, in each of **at least two** texts on your comparative course. Support your answer with reference to your chosen texts. (40)

C SOCIAL SETTING

1. (a) (i) Name **one** of the comparative texts you have studied and identify the aspect of the social setting that you found most memorable. Use one or more key moment(s) to help explain why you found this aspect of the social setting so memorable. Support your answer with reference to the text. (15)

(ii) Name **another** comparative text you have studied and identify the aspect of the social setting that you found most memorable. Use one or more key moment(s) to help explain why you found this aspect of the social setting so memorable. Support your answer with reference to the text. (15)

(b) Identify an aspect of the social setting in each of **at least two** comparative texts you have studied. Compare the extent to which these aspects of the social setting changed or remained the same over time in your chosen texts.
You may refer to the same aspect or different aspects of social setting in each of your chosen texts.
Support your answer with reference to your chosen texts. (40)

OR

2. (a) (i) Name **one** of the comparative texts you have studied and explain why, in your opinion, tension was or was not evident because of the social setting of this text. Support your answer with reference to the text. (15)

(ii) Name **another** of the comparative texts you have studied and explain why, in your opinion, tension was or was not evident because of the social setting of this text. Support your answer with reference to the text. (15)

(b) Identify an aspect of the social setting in each of **at least two** comparative texts you have studied. Compare the extent to which these aspects of the social setting changed or remained the same over time in your chosen texts. You may refer to the same aspect or different aspects of social setting in each of your chosen texts. Support your answer with reference to your chosen texts. (40)

SECTION III POETRY (70 MARKS)

Candidates must answer the questions on the Unseen Poem **and** the questions on **one** of the Prescribed Poems – A, B, C, D, E, F.

UNSEEN POEM (20 marks)

Read the following poem, and the questions that follow, at least twice before writing your answers.

Three Good Things

At day's end I remember
three good things.

Apples maybe – their skinshine smell
and soft froth of juice.

Water maybe – the pond in the park
dark, and full of secret fish.

A mountain maybe – that I saw in a film,
or climbed last holiday,
and suddenly today it thundered up
into a playground game.
Or else an owl - I heard an owl today,
And I made bread.
My head is full of all these things,
It's hard to choose just three.

I let remembering fill me up
with all good things
so that good things will overflow
into my sleeping self,

and in the morning
good things will be waiting
when I wake. *Jan Dean*

1. The poet in the above poem is effective in appealing to our senses. Identify the place where, in your view, the poet is most effective in appealing to our senses. Explain your choice with reference to the poem. (10)

2. From reading the above poem, which of the following word or words do you think accurately describes the tone or mood of this poem?

Hopeful Reflective Challenging

Explain your response with reference to the poem. (10)

PRESCRIBED POETRY (50 marks)

You must answer on **ONE** of the following poems: (**A - F**)

A STREET

He fell in love with the butcher's daughter
When he saw her passing by in her white trousers
Dangling a knife on a ring at her belt.
He stared at the dark shining drops on the paving stones.

One day he followed her
Down the slanting lane at the back of the shambles.
A door stood half-open
And the stairs were brushed and clean,
Her shoes paired on the bottom step,
Each tread marked with the red crescent
Her bare heels left, fading to the faintest at the top.

E. Ní Chuilleanáin

1. (a) Based on your reading of the above poem, what impression do you form of the butcher's daughter? Support your answer with reference to the poem. (15)

(b) Do you think Ní Chuilleanáin has chosen a good title for this poem? Support your answer with reference to the poem. (15)

2. Answer **ONE** of the following: [Each part carries 20 marks]

(i) Eiléan Ní Chuilleanáin makes readers use their imaginations when engaging with her poem *"Street"*. Do you agree? Explain your answer using the poem to support your response.

OR

(ii) Which of the following word or words would you choose to describe this poem?

Thought-provoking Menacing Confusing

Explain your response with reference to the poem.

OR

(iii) You have been invited to contribute to a radio programme called 'Poetry Craft', which discusses popular poets and their work. You have been asked to explain why the language used by Ní Chuilleanáin in her poem, "Street" appeals to you. Write the text of the contribution you would make. Support your response with reference to the poem.

B Extract from THEY CLAPPED

they clapped when we landed
thinking africa was just an extension
of the black world
they smiled as we taxied home to be met
black to black face not understanding africans lack
color prejudice…
… they stopped running when they learned the packages
on the women's heads were heavy and that babies didn't
cry and that disease is uncomfortable and that villages are fun
only because you knew the feel of good leather on good
pavement
they cried when they saw mercedes benz were as common
in lagos as volkswagens are in berlin
they shook their heads when they understood there was no
difference between the french and the english and the americans
and the afro-americans or the tribe next door or the country
across the border…
they clapped when they took off
for home despite the dead
dream they saw a free future *Nikki Giovanni*

1. (a) Based on your reading of the extract above, what impression do you form of Africa? Support your answer with reference to the extract. (15)

(b) Do you think that the visitors enjoyed their visit to Africa?
Explain your answer with reference to the poem. You may refer to the whole poem in your response. (15)

2. Answer **ONE** of the following: [Each part carries 20 marks]

(i) Nikki Giovanni, makes us think about how we view other people and other places, when engaging with "They Clapped". Do you agree? Explain your answer using the poem to support your response. You may refer to the whole poem in your response.

OR

(ii) Which of the following word or words would you choose to describe this poem?

Amusing Thought-Provoking Optimistic

Explain your response with reference to the poem. You may refer to the whole poem in your response.

OR

(iii) You have been invited to contribute to a radio programme called 'Poetry Craft', which discusses popular poets and their work. You have been asked to explain why the language used by Giovanni in her poem, "They Clapped" appeals to you. Write the text of the contribution you would make. Support your response with reference to the poem. You may refer to the whole poem in your response.

C NEW LIBERTY HALL

Higher than county lark
Can fly, a speck that sings,
Sixteen-floored Liberty Hall
Goes up through scaffoldings
In memory of Larkin,
Shot Connolly. With cap
On simple head, hallmark
Of sweat, new capitalists
Rent out expensive suites
Of glassier offices,
Babel'd above our streets,
The unemployed may scoff, but
Workers must skimp and save
To own so fine a skyscraper,
Beyond the dream of Gandon,
Shaming the Custom House
The giant crane, the gantries.
Labour is not accustomed
To living higher. Railing
Is gone that I leaned against
To watch that figure, tall and lean,
Jim Larkin, shouting, railing.
Why should he give a damn
That day for English grammar,
Arm-waving, eloquent?
On top, a green pagoda
Has glorified cement,
Umbrella'd the sun. Go, da,
And shiver in your tenement.

Austin Clarke

1. (a) Based on your reading of the above poem, what impression do you form of the new building, Liberty Hall?
Support your answer with reference to the poem. (15)

(b) Do you think Austin Clarke has chosen a good title for this poem? Explain your answer with reference to the poem. (15)

2. Answer **ONE** of the following: [Each part carries 20 marks]

(i) Austin Clarke, uses history and historical figures cleverly, to help us to fully understand his poem, "New Liberty Hall". Do you agree? Explain your answer using the poem to support your response.

OR

(ii) Which of the following word or words would you choose to describe this poem?

Angry Thought-Provoking Pessimistic

Explain your response with reference to the poem.

OR

(iii) You have been invited to contribute to a radio programme called 'Poetry Craft', which discusses popular poets and their work. You have been asked to explain why the language used by Clarke in his poem, "New Liberty Hall" appeals to you. Write the text of the contribution you would make. Support your response with reference to the poem.

D **BUYING WINKLES**

My mother would spare me sixpence and say,
'Hurry up now and don't be talking to strange
men on the way.' I'd dash from the ghosts
on the stairs where the bulb had blown
out into Gardiner Street, all relief.
A bonus if the moon was in a strip of sky
between the tall houses, or stars out,
but even in rain I was happy – the winkles
would be wet and glisten blue like little
night skies themselves. I'd hold the tanner tight
and jump every crack in the pavement,
I'd wave up to women at sills or those
lingering in doorways and weave a glad path through
men heading out for the night.

She'd be sitting outside the Rosebowl Bar
on an orange-crate, a pram loaded
with pails of winkles before her.
When the bar doors swung open they'd leak
the smell of men together with drink
and I saw light in golden mirrors.
I envied each soul in the hot interior,

I'd ask her again to show me the right way
to do *it*. She'd take a pin from her shawl –
'Open the eyelid. So. Stick it in
till you feel a grip, then slither him out.
Gently, mind.' The sweetest extra winkle
that brought the sea to me.
'Tell yer Ma I picked them fresh this morning.'

I'd bear the newspaper twists
Bulging fat with winkles
Proudly home, like torches. *Paula Meehan*

1. (a) Based on your reading of the above poem, what impression do you form of Paula Meehan's neighbourhood? Support your answer with reference to the poem. (15)

(b) Do you think that Paula Meehan enjoyed her childhood years? Support your explanation with reference to the poem. (15)

2. Answer **ONE** of the following: [Each part carries 20 marks]

(i) Paula Meehan makes readers use their senses to help them engage with her poem "Buying Winkles". Do you agree? Explain your answer using the poem to support your response.

OR

(ii) Which of the following word or words would you choose to describe this poem?

Nostalgic Colourful Realistic

Explain your response with reference to the poem.

OR

(iii) You have been invited to contribute to a radio programme called 'Poetry Craft', which discusses popular poets and their work. You have been asked to explain why the language used by Meehan in her poem, "Buying Winkles" appeals to you. Write the text of the contribution you would make. Support your response with reference to the poem.

E **THE THOUGHT-FOX**

I imagine this midnight moment's forest:
Something else is alive
Beside the clock's loneliness
And this blank page where my fingers move.

Through the window I see no star:
Something more near
Though deeper within darkness
Is entering the loneliness:

Cold, delicately as the dark snow,
A fox's nose touches twig, leaf;
Two eyes serve a movement, that now
And again now, and now, and now

Sets neat prints into the snow
Between trees, and warily a lame
Shadow lags by stump and in hollow
Of a body that is bold to come

Across clearings, an eye,
A widening deepening greenness,
Brilliantly, concentratedly,
Coming about its own business

Till, with a sudden sharp hot stink of fox
It enters the dark hole of the head.
The window is starless still; the clock ticks,
The page is printed. *Ted Hughes*

1. (a) What do you learn about the process of writing poetry from reading the above poem? Support your answer with reference to the poem. (15)

(b) Do you think Hughes has chosen a good title for this poem? Support your answer with reference to the poem. (15)

2. Answer **ONE** of the following: [Each part carries 20 marks]

(i) Ted Hughes, makes readers use their senses to help them engage with his poem "The Thought-Fox". Do you agree? Explain your answer using the poem to support your response.

OR

(ii) Which of the following word or words would you choose to describe this poem?

Mysterious Revealing Confusing

Explain your response with reference to the poem.

OR

(iii) You have been invited to contribute to a radio programme called 'Poetry Craft', which discusses popular poets and their work. You have been asked to explain why the language used by Hughes in his poem, "The Thought-Fox" appeals to you. Write the text of the contribution you would make. Support your response with reference to the poem.

F **Inversnaid**

This darksome burn, horseback brown,
His rollrock highroad roaring down,
In coop and in comb the fleece of his foam
Flutes and low to the lake falls home.

A windpuff-bonnet of fawn-froth
Turns and twindles over the broth
Of a pool so pitchblack, fell-frowning,
It rounds and rounds Despair to drowning.

Degged with dew, dappled with dew
Are the groins of the braes that the brook threads through,
Wiry heathpacks, flitches of fern,
And the beadbonny ash that sits over the burn.

What would the world be, once bereft
Of wet and of wildness? Let them be left,
O let them be left, wildness and wet;
Long live the weeds and the wilderness yet.

Gerard Manley Hopkins

1. (a) Based on your reading of the above poem, what impression do you form of nature? Support your answer with reference to the poem. (15)

(b) Do you agree with the views the poet expresses in the final stanza of this poem? Explain your answer with reference to the poem. (15)

2. Answer **ONE** of the following: [Each part carries 20 marks]

(i) Gerard Manley Hopkins, makes readers use their senses to help them engage with his poem "Inversnaid". Do you agree? Explain your answer using the poem to support your response.

OR

(ii) Which of the following word or words would you choose to describe this poem:

Original Optimistic Energetic

Explain your response with reference to the poem.

OR

(iii) You have been invited to contribute to a radio programme called 'Poetry Craft', which discusses popular poets and their work. You have been asked to explain why the language used by Hopkins in his poem, "Inversnaid" appeals to you. Write the text of the contribution you would make. Support your response with reference to the poem.

Copyright notice

This examination paper may contain texts or images for which the State Examinations Commission is not the copyright holder, and which may have been adapted, for the purpose of assessment, without the authors' prior consent. This examination paper has been prepared in accordance with Section 53(5) of the *Copyright and Related Rights Act, (2000).* Any subsequent use for a purpose other than the intended purpose is not authorised. The Commission does not accept liability for any infringement of third-party rights arising from unauthorised distribution or use of this examination paper.

This document must be handed up at the end of the examination.